

Planning Outcomes

Benefits

- **How it helps the business owner:** It allows the business owner to explore issues and ideas with an open heart and mind, discover what they have been missing, record key learnings, and build an actionable plan forward. It also provides clarity across the four core planning domains: Business Targets, Strategic Orientation, Organisational Review, and Sales & Marketing Review.
- **How it helps the advisor:** It establishes the advisor's role explicitly as challenging what the client believes to be true, structuring the scope of the planning session, and managing collaborative thinking.
- **Who it may be suitable for:** Business owners and leadership teams preparing for a formal business planning session who need a broad scope assessment of their revenue goals, business model, team efficiencies, and marketing strategy.

Step-by-Step Methods for Practical Use

1. **Pre-Session Preparation:** Define clear "walk-away" expectations before starting the meeting. Gather past planning documents, financial reports, and software models. Select which specific frameworks across the 4 planning domains will be included in the session scope.
2. **Set Session Roles & Mindset:** Establish that the advisor's role is to challenge existing beliefs, while the client's role is to explore ideas openly. Use De Bono's 6 hats / parallel thinking to manage dominant personalities and maintain collaborative problem-solving.
3. **Execute Domain Reviews:** Walk through the selected planning domains sequentially:
 - *Business Targets:* Define revenue, profit, personal income goals, risk tolerance, and work hour expectations.
 - *Strategic Orientation:* Conduct a challenging review of revenue streams, asset application, target markets, and scenario modeling.
 - *Organisational Review:* Analyze communication channels, divisional roles, and individual responsibilities to enhance team engagement.

- *Sales & Marketing Review*: Assess customer attention, conversion mechanisms, packaging, pricing, and loyalty programs.
 - 4. **Capture & Reflect**: Employ contrast models (Before–Present–Future). Assign a note-taker to stop every 30 minutes and read back significant points and decisions. Allow time to "retire and reflect" if core business beliefs are challenged.
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Bizz Targets

Benefits

- **How it helps the business owner**: It helps the business owner explicitly record personal income goals, leisure/lifestyle expectations, required business scale dynamics, and tactical profit lever quick wins.
- **How it helps the advisor**: It provides a structured methodology to facilitate parallel (collaborative) thinking during goal setting, avoiding time-consuming arguments or false consensus traps.
- **Who it may be suitable for**: Business owners who need to align personal lifestyle desires with quantifiable operational targets and profit driver actions.

Step-by-Step Methods for Practical Use

1. **Align Collaborative Mindset**: Introduce parallel thinking using the 4-sided building analogy to ensure all participants inspect the same operational aspects together rather than arguing from opposing views.
2. **Log Owner Expectations**: Complete the Business Owner Expectations table to record desired personal income, leisure time/leave goals, and effective work habits.
3. **Calculate Scale Dynamics**: Complete the Business Development Stages table to compute required business performance and scale dynamics needed to achieve personal goals (dark bands calculate automatically).
4. **Formulate Operational Objectives**: Establish clear operational goals that define specific tactical objectives.
5. **Analyze the 8 Profit Levers**: Review the mathematical formulas for Total Revenue ($\text{Foot-traffic} \times \text{Prospects} \times \text{Customers} \times \text{Avg Spend} \times \text{Frequency}$) and

Total Expenses (**Sales Margin+Activity Driven Costs+Fixed Overhead Costs**).

6. **Identify Quick Wins:** Populate Profit Lever tables 1 and 2 with actionable tasks (identifying at least 1 task per lever if short on time).
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Strategic Orientation.1

Benefits

- **How it helps the business owner:** It educates business owners on formal planning terminology, evaluates internal/external business positions, and establishes observable, time-bound operational milestones grounded in strategic logic.
- **How it helps the advisor:** It offers a 6-step formal planning process to guide clients from positional assessment through scenario modeling to delegated tactical execution, utilizing "Field Intelligence".
- **Who it may be suitable for:** Business leaders seeking to establish shared strategic language across their executive team, conduct SWOT/PEST assessments, and build structured action plans.

Step-by-Step Methods for Practical Use

1. **Assess Current Position:** Review pre-gathered team insights, customer insights, financial reports, asset performance, and complete the SWOT analysis table.
 2. **Develop Strategic Scenarios:** Utilize P.E.S.T prompts to identify external drivers and construct a Scenario Matrix using the two greatest impact drivers.
 3. **Determine Strategic Objective & Strategy:** Define a singular, desired end result (Strategic Objective) and agree on the underlying ethos/philosophy (Strategy) using 4-Box Strategic Language.
 4. **Set Operational Objectives:** Filter proposed operational goals against three mandatory tests: Observable/Measurable, Time-bound, and Direct support of the Strategic Objective.
 5. **Assign Tactics & Automated Reminders:** Detail specific tactical actions (Task, Whom, When) and log them into the Automated Action Plan Reminder.
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Strategic Orientation.2

Benefits

- **How it helps the business owner:** It exposes psychological growth barriers ("Psyche Errors" like role-identification or optimism bias) and introduces frameworks (Sigmoid Curve, Technology Points, Deming Volatility, Blue Ocean) to time business decisions and pricing.
- **How it helps the advisor:** It provides diagnostic tools to uncover why clients stall, offers pricing matrices across problem-solving levels and delivery mediums, and models system feedback loops.
- **Who it may be suitable for:** Mature business owners facing growth plateaus, succession friction, product obsolescence, or complex pricing and supply-chain choices.

Step-by-Step Methods for Practical Use

1. **Identify Business Stage & Psyche Error:** Locate current position on the 7 Growth Focus Tactics curve and diagnose matching Psyche Errors (Role-Identification, Over-Exposure, Optimism Bias, Complacency, Confirmation Bias).
 2. **Apply Market & Life Cycle Frameworks:** Assess market pressure via Porter's 5 Forces, map product decay on the Product Life Cycle, identify critical price points on Technology Points, and locate point X/Y on the Sigmoid Curve to time new product launches.
 3. **Structure Pricing & Delivery Tiers:** Fill out the Price For Problem Solving table (Free / Tell, Fee / Show, Premium Fee / With, Maximum Fee / For) and Delivery Medium table (Once to Many, One to Many, One to One).
 4. **Analyze Integration & Revenue Options:** Review Vertical Integration (securing margin vs. quality), Horizontal Integration (consumable/perishable offerings), Boston Model, Risk Reward Matrix (testing one unknown at a time), and Upstream/Downstream Revenue Streams.
 5. **Map Systems & Volatility:** Diagram system feedback loops using Senge's Circles of Causality and categorize operational variance into Deming's 4 Volatility Causes (Common, Special, Seasonal, Tampering).
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Profit Levers & Blue Ocean

Benefits

- **How it helps the business owner:** It helps business owners escape saturated "Red Water" competition fronts and turn post-it note brainstorming ideas into structured profit lever quick wins.
- **How it helps the advisor:** It streamlines delivery focus by providing clear prompts to challenge assumptions around price/quality trade-offs and rapidly build a TASK, WHOM, WHEN execution sheet.
- **Who it may be suitable for:** Business owners competing in crowded markets who need clear differentiation or rapid, incremental profit improvements.

Step-by-Step Methods for Practical Use

1. **Review Competition Fronts:** Examine standard industry competition fronts in the "Red Water Zone" (price, quality, location, consistency).
 2. **Map Blue Ocean Differentiation:** Brainstorm key customer frustrations/frictions; tick fronts currently focused on and circle fronts planned for future competition to remove purchasing blockages.
 3. **Brainstorm Operational Activities:** Write potential activities (pricing, packaging, bundling, brand awareness, inventory, sales messaging) onto post-it notes.
 4. **Sort Against 8 Profit Levers:** Place post-it notes under the corresponding 8 Profit Levers to capture accumulative incremental growth.
 5. **Create Action Plan:** Convert selected lever tasks into a simple TASK, WHOM, WHEN prioritization table.
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S.W.O.T PEST

Benefits

- **How it helps the business owner:** It gives the business owner a structured overview of internal operational factors (personnel, POS reports, efficiency) and external macro-environmental trends (political, economic, regulatory, tariffs).
- **How it helps the advisor:** It offers a comprehensive dual-analysis prompt set (SWOT + PEST) to challenge client assumptions and identify growth drag or joint venture potential.

- **Who it may be suitable for:** Business owners conducting a baseline assessment of their current market standing or preparing for local/international expansion.

Step-by-Step Methods for Practical Use

1. **Examine Internal Position (Strengths & Weaknesses):** Review internal personnel roles, communication lines, POS report accuracy, profit lines, technology usage, and financial instruments used to reduce risk/'growth drag'.
 2. **Examine External Environment (PEST Prompts):** Evaluate Opportunities and Threats triggered by political, economic, interest rate, consumer confidence, and regulatory/tariff changes.
 3. **Assess Market Capabilities:** Explore joint venture opportunities, cross-selling potential, customer 'ring fencing' strategies, and technological/environmental industry factors.
 4. **Log Inputs:** Record observations as they arise into the designated 4-quadrant SWOT/PEST table.
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Business Dating

Benefits

- **How it helps the business owner:** It protects business owners from high-risk, hasty business amalgamations by establishing a progressive relationship model (One Night Stand → Dating → Engaged → Married) to evaluate commercial alignment and cultural fit.
- **How it helps the advisor:** It supplies advisors with a structured narrative and matrix to guide two business entities (such as family businesses) through low-risk strategic alliances prior to full mergers.
- **Who it may be suitable for:** Business owners considering joint ventures, strategic alliances, family business amalgamations, or business acquisitions.

Step-by-Step Methods for Practical Use

1. **Classify Relationship Stage:** Categorize the potential business relationship into one of 4 stages: One Night Stand (singular contract/project), Dating (ongoing working partnership), Engaged (preparing mentally/financially for merger), or Married (fully merged entity).

2. **Plot Security vs. Commitment:** Map the prospective alliance onto the 2x2 grid charting Attraction/Security against Attraction/Commitment.
 3. **Structure a "Business Date":** Instead of an immediate acquisition, execute a 12-month trial period with purchase valuations set at the outset and a 12-month right of fulfillment allowing clean withdrawal.
 4. **Test Cultural Fit:** Utilize the dating period to allow teams and stakeholders to test working relationships and integrate cultures under low-strain conditions.
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Pivot

Benefits

- **How it helps the business owner:** It empowers agile business owners with a rapid 5-step strategic process to identify market resistance, refine marketing messaging, and test prototype offerings with minimal risk.
- **How it helps the advisor:** It provides a structured pipeline to guide clients through forced changes, craft high-converting AIDCRA advertisements, and establish strict test parameters.
- **Who it may be suitable for:** Agile business owners needing to rapidly pivot their strategy, introduce new products, or overcome market resistance.

Step-by-Step Methods for Practical Use

1. **Identify the Resistance:** Analyze market pressure using Porter's 5 Forces, Market Diffusion Theory (15% tipping point), Product Life Cycle, Technology Points, and Sigmoid Curve to determine "What's forcing the change?".
2. **Choose Competition Fronts:** Select competition fronts across Blue Ocean, Vertical, or Horizontal Integration models, and log initial observations and responses.
3. **Rehearse the Message:** Answer the 6 Critical Marketing Questions (target profile, concerns, constraints, special factors, value added, messaging channels) and build an ad using the AIDCRA framework (Attention, Interest, Desire, Credibility, Risk Removal, Action).
4. **Trial the Prototype:** Define budget and timeline test parameters for product development, market research, competitor analysis, team learning, prototype solution, and messaging appeal.

5. **Do It & Review It:** Execute the prototype trial within set parameters and evaluate performance metrics.
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Porter's & Pine

Benefits

- **How it helps the business owner:** It enables business owners to analyze competitive market forces while simultaneously shifting their offering up the economic value chain from commoditized goods to authentic, high-margin customer experiences.
- **How it helps the advisor:** It allows advisors to run a focused dual-framework session emphasizing genuine customer connection as the core engine for premium pricing and customer retention.
- **Who it may be suitable for:** Business owners operating in traditional service or commodity markets seeking to increase profit margins and build customer loyalty.

Step-by-Step Methods for Practical Use

1. **Assess 5 Forces Pressure:** Evaluate competitive pressures (Customers, Suppliers, Substitutes, New Entrants, Existing Rivals) to determine expected threats, opportunities, and financial returns.
2. **Map Economic Value Progression:** Trace the product/service offering along Pine's Progression of Economic Value (Commodity → Goods → Services → Experience → Authenticity).
3. **Align Imperatives & Sensitivities:** Pair economic outputs with corresponding business imperatives and consumer sensitivities (Commodity/Supply/Availability, Goods/Quality Control/Costs, Services/Improve/Quality, Experience/Render/Authenticity).
4. **Establish Customer Connection:** Implement mechanisms to bring both business owner and customer onto the same emotional level via sincere efforts to 'connect'.
5. **Document Strategy:** Fill out the Progression of Economic Development table to record observations and strategic responses.